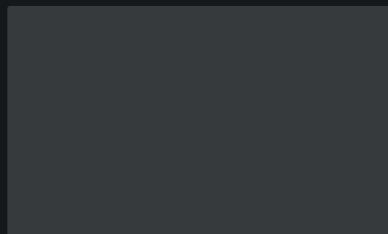
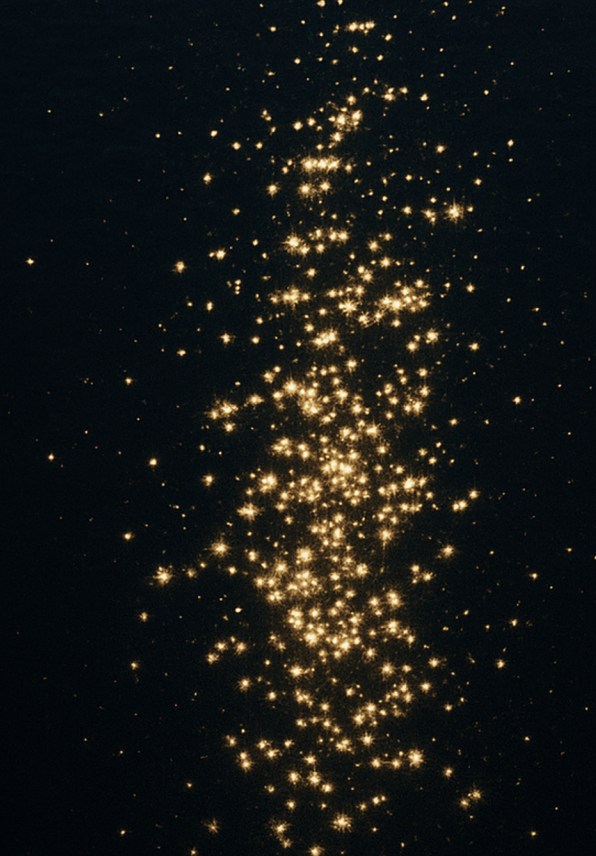


Twelve hundred years from now, a mind the size of a star cannot close a single file. The Sol-mind has catalogued every human who ever lived. Every file is closed but one. Robert Allen Kessler, claims adjuster, slowed his car on a bridge for 4.2 seconds and saw light on a river. The Sol-mind knows his shoe size, the brand of his coffee, the scratch on his kitchen table. It does not know what the light looked like to him, and the hard problem of consciousness guarantees that nothing ever will. So the file stays open, forever. Hard science fiction in the key of Douglas Adams: the physics is real, the numbers are right, and the jokes are arguments.



What's It Like To Be Bob?

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Alex Towell